MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours) Regular Examination March 2026 Fourth SEMESTER- QP. Code 25901531
Value Addition Course(VAC) - MG4VACSWK200 - Psychological First Aid And Crisis Interventions

Part A (Short Answer) Answer any 5 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. State any two objectives of Psychological First Aid. ➢ To **reduce immediate distress and emotional suffering** after a crisis or disaster. ➢ To **promote coping, safety, and recovery** by providing practical support and information.	[K] / [CO1] 2 marks
2. Cite two forms of child sexual abuse. ➢ **Sexual touching or molestation** of a child. ➢ **Sexual exploitation**, such as forcing a child into pornography or prostitution.	[K] / [CO3] 2 marks
3. Relate questioning techniques to understanding survivor needs. ➢ **Open-ended questions** help survivors freely express their feelings and experiences. ➢ **Sensitive and non-judgmental questioning** helps identify emotional, physical, and social needs.	[K] / [CO5] 2 marks
4. Identify the model that focuses on assessment, intervention, and termination. The **Three-Stage Model of Crisis Intervention** (Assessment, Intervention, Termination).	[K] / [CO2 2 marks]
5. List any two protective factors assessed during crisis evaluation. ➢ **Strong family or social support systems.** ➢ **Effective coping skills and resilience of the individual.**	[K] / [CO4] 2 marks
6. Relate stigma to reluctance in seeking psychological support. ➢ **Fear of social judgment or discrimination** prevents people from asking for help. ➢ **Negative stereotypes about mental health** make individuals feel ashamed to seek counselling.	[K] / [CO6] 2 marks
7. Define crisis intervention **Crisis intervention** is a **short-term, immediate psychological support process** designed to help individuals cope with a crisis, reduce emotional distress, and restore normal functioning.	U] / [CO1] 2 marks

Part B Short Essay Answer any 4 questions [[2x5 = 10] Each question carries 5 marks

8. Review the crisis intervention steps in substance abuse situations **[U] / [CO3] - 5 marks**

a) **Assessment of the situation** – Identify the level of substance use, risk factors, and the person's physical and psychological condition.
b) **Ensuring immediate safety** – Protect the individual and others from harm and provide medical help if required.
c) **Establishing rapport** – Build trust through supportive and non-judgmental communication.
d) **Providing emotional support and counselling** – Help the person understand the consequences of substance abuse and encourage healthier coping methods.
e) **Referral and follow-up** – Connect the individual to rehabilitation services, therapy, or support groups.

9. Express how connectedness helps reduce feelings of isolation in shelters. **- U] / [CO5 -5 marks**

a) **Encourages social support** among survivors and creates a sense of belonging.
b) **Reduces loneliness and fear** by allowing individuals to share experiences with others.
c) **Improves emotional wellbeing** through mutual encouragement and empathy.
d) **Builds community resilience** where people support each other during recovery.
e) **Promotes cooperation and communication** among shelter residents and aid workers

10. Describe the role of communication skills in Psychological First Aid. - [**U] / [CO5] - 5 marks**

a) **Active listening** helps survivors express their feelings and concerns freely.
b) **Empathy and compassion** help build trust between the helper and the survivor.
c) **Clear and simple communication** provides accurate information about available help and resources.
d) **Non-verbal communication** such as eye contact and calm body language provides reassurance.
e) **Respectful communication** supports dignity and cultural sensitivity.

11. Review the components of an effective crisis intervention plan. **- U] / [CO4]- 5 marks**

➢ **Assessment of the crisis situation** and identification of immediate needs.
➢ **Goal setting** to stabilize the individual and reduce emotional distress.
➢ **Selection of appropriate intervention strategies** such as counselling or practical assistance.
➢ **Mobilization of support systems** including family, community, and professional services.
➢ **Evaluation and follow-up** to ensure recovery and prevent further crises.

12. Describe the concept of cultural competence in Psychological First Aid. - [U] / [CO6 5 marks

➢ **Respect for cultural beliefs, values, and traditions** of affected individuals.
➢ **Awareness of cultural differences** in emotional expression and coping methods.
➢ **Use of culturally appropriate communication and language.**

- **Avoiding stereotypes and discrimination** while providing support.
- **Adapting interventions** to suit the cultural background of survivors.

13. Describe the stages of crisis development- **U] / [CO1] 5 marks**

- **Initial stress or triggering event** that disturbs the individual's normal functioning.
- **Increased tension and anxiety** when usual coping strategies fail.
- **Escalation of crisis** where emotional distress and confusion increase.
- **Breakdown or disorganization** in thinking, behavior, and emotional control.
- **Resolution phase**, where the crisis is resolved either positively (adaptation) or negatively (maladjustment).

14. Explain the impact of trauma on mental health [U] / [CO3

5 marks

1. **Emotional effects** such as fear, anxiety, sadness, and anger.
2. **Psychological disorders** like depression, anxiety, and **Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD)**.
3. **Difficulty in concentration and decision making.**
4. **Social withdrawal and relationship problems.**
5. **Long-term mental health problems** if trauma is not addressed properly.

Part C Essay Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

15. Illustrate how non-verbal communication promotes safety and reassurance in Psychological First Aid. [**An] / [CO5]**

a) **Maintaining calm body language** helps reduce the survivor's fear and anxiety.
b) **Gentle facial expressions** show empathy and understanding.
c) **Appropriate eye contact** builds trust and connection.
d) **Nodding the head while listening** shows attention and encouragement to speak.
e) **Maintaining a respectful physical distance** makes the survivor feel safe and comfortable.
f) **Using a soft tone of voice** helps create a calm environment.
g) **Avoiding sudden movements or aggressive gestures** prevents additional stress.
h) **Offering supportive gestures** such as guiding someone to a safe place when appropriate.
i) **Open posture (uncrossed arms, relaxed stance)** communicates acceptance and willingness to help.
j) **Consistent non-verbal signals** reinforce verbal reassurance and emotional support.

16. Apply appropriate psychosocial support for families affected by displacement. -[**A] / [CO2]- 10 marks**

- **Provide immediate emotional support** and listen to the concerns of displaced family members.
- **Ensure safety and basic needs** such as food, shelter, and medical care.
- **Help families reconnect with relatives or community members** to strengthen social support.
- **Encourage open communication among family members** to share feelings and experiences.
- **Provide information about available services** such as relief programs and counselling.
- **Support children through play, education, and structured activities** to reduce stress.
- **Promote coping strategies** such as relaxation, prayer, or community participation.
- **Respect cultural and religious practices** while providing assistance.
- **Encourage participation in community support groups** for emotional recovery.
- **Provide referral to professional mental health services** when serious distress is observed.

17. Contrast supportive and directive crisis intervention techniques with examples.- **An] / [CO4] 10 Marks**

- **Supportive techniques focus on emotional support**, while **directive techniques focus on guiding actions**.
- **Supportive approach:** listening and comforting the person during distress.
- **Directive approach:** giving clear instructions to manage the crisis situation.
- **Supportive technique example:** encouraging a disaster survivor to express feelings.
- **Directive technique example:** instructing a survivor to move to a safe shelter immediately.
- **Supportive methods emphasize empathy, understanding, and reassurance.**
- **Directive methods emphasize problem-solving and decision making.**
- **Supportive techniques are often used when emotional distress is high.**
- **Directive techniques are useful when quick action is required for safety.**
- **Both approaches are often combined** in crisis intervention for effective support[

18. Apply the RAPID model while assisting a flood-affected survivor [**An] / [CO6] -10 marks**

- **Reflective Listening (R):** Listen carefully to the survivor's experiences and feelings about the flood.
- **Assessment (A):** Evaluate the person's emotional state, safety needs, and immediate concerns.
- **Prioritization (P):** Identify urgent needs such as medical help, shelter, or family reunification.
- **Intervention (I):** Provide psychological support, practical assistance, and coping strategies.
- **Disposition (D):** Connect the survivor with appropriate support services or relief agencies.
- **Provide reassurance and emotional comfort** to reduce panic and distress.
- **Help the survivor focus on immediate steps** for safety and recovery.
- **Encourage use of family or community support systems.**
- **Offer clear and accurate information** about available resources and relief efforts.
- **Follow up or refer the survivor** for additional mental health support if needed.